The Sara Morning

Friday, 16 October 2026 BACKFILLED EDITION 12 stories · 16 sources

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1. Union Savings Bank increased its investment in the Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF by over 200 percent.
2. Seventeen NATO nations are participating in the annual Steadfast Noon nuclear deterrence exercises hosted in Italy.
3. Official figures reveal unexpected growth in the UK economy, defying predictions that it would shrink.

Union Savings Bank Expands Stake in Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF

Union Savings Bank raised its investment by over 200 percent as multiple institutions adjusted their positions in the fund.

- Union Savings Bank acquired 5,880 additional shares of Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF during the third quarter. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "The institutional investor owned 8,583 shares of the ETF's stock after buying an additional 5,880 shares during the period."

- The ETF position represents 1.3% of the bank's total portfolio and is valued at over $3.2 million. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "Union Savings Bank's holdings in Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF were worth $3,212,000 as of its most recent SEC filing."

- Other wealth management firms also altered their positions in Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF over the same period. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "A number of other hedge funds also recently made changes to their positions in VTI."

- Institutional ownership accounts for slightly under twenty-nine percent of the fund. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "28.92% of the stock is currently owned by institutional investors."

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source
themarketsdaily.com

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CLIMATE CHANGE



Italy Hosts NATO Steadfast Noon Nuclear Exercise

Seventeen NATO nations participate in the annual nuclear deterrence drills hosted in Italy, utilizing dual-capable aircraft and mock nuclear weapons.

- Italy is hosting NATO's Steadfast Noon annual nuclear deterrence exercise from October 13 to 23, 2026. [yourdemocracy.net.au]

  > "From October 13 to 23, 2026, Italy is hosting NATO's annual nuclear deterrence exercise Steadfast Noon."

- The exercise features a record number of 17 participating NATO countries compared to previous years. [yourdemocracy.net.au]

  > "This year's exercise boasts a record number of participants – 17 NATO countries, compared to 14 in 2025 and 13 in 2024."

- The exercises involve approximately 70 military aircraft and over 2,000 personnel training with mock nuclear warheads. [yourdemocracy.net.au]

  > "The exercise involves around 70 military aircraft and over 2,000 service personnel."

In the image: A satirical political cartoon depicting exaggerated claims about NATO plans alongside caricatures of historical figures such as Hitler and Napoleon, an exploding nuclear bomb, and cartoon animals.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

yourdemocracy.net.au

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Climate Change and El Niño Fueled Record-Breaking Hurricane Polo

A new study reveals that global warming and El Niño combined to intensify Hurricane Polo, with climate change having the greater impact.

- Hurricane Polo was the longest-lasting Category 5 storm ever recorded in the Pacific, setting a record of two and a half days. [aol.co.uk]

  > "the longest-lasting Category 5 storm ever to churn in the Pacific"

- Climate change added nearly 10 kph to the storm's strength, while El Niño contributed about 8 kph. [aol.co.uk]

  > "adding nearly 10 kph to its already monstrous strength, according to a joint study published on 14 October by scientists from World Weather Attribution and Climate Central. El Niño contributed a bit less, about 8 kph"

- Climate change made the conducive conditions 23 times more likely, compared to 14 times more likely for El Niño. [aol.co.uk]

  > "Climate change made the conditions that fuelled the hurricane 23 times more likely, while El Niño – the natural and temporary warming of parts of the Pacific – made it 14 times more likely"

In the image: The image illustrates severe flood conditions, downed utility poles, and displaced residents following a powerful storm, which complements the text's discussion of hurricane damage.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

aol.co.uk

You engaged with 7 of 13 Climate change stories you saw

Ancient Footprints Reveal How Climate Change Reshaped Early Americans

New research shows how environmental shifts during the Ice Age challenged the first people in America.

- Human footprints at White Sands date back approximately 23,000 years, contradicting prior population theories.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > “human footprints at White Sands, which date back to about 23,000 years ago”

- Around 24,200 years ago, Lake Otero sat in the area with cooler temperatures and conifer forests.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > “Lake Otero was located in the White Sands area, which consisted of the surrounding landscapes that had conifer forests”

- Over a span of 2,000 years, the regional climate warmed, vegetation dried, and the lake shrank.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > “there occurred a change in temperatures and landscape. The conifers disappeared, and their place was taken by oaks and sagebrush”

- Researchers analyzed sediment pollen and organic compounds to understand historical precipitation and temperature conditions.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > “studied the sediments of the White Sands area, which were rich in fossilised pollen indicating information about vegetation”

In the image: The image illustrates a group of early humans gathered near a lake and forest landscape, which is not depicted in the source text's scientific data tables.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

economictimes.indiatimes.com

You engaged with 7 of 13 Climate change stories you saw

Study Finds Global Warming Outpaced El Niño in Fueling Hurricane Polo

A new scientific study reveals that climate change contributed more to the intensity of record-breaking Hurricane Polo than El Niño.

- Climate change added about 6 mph to Hurricane Polo's strength, while El Niño contributed roughly 5 mph.
  [bostonherald.com]
  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]
  [whec.com][wsls.com]
  > “adding about 6 mph (nearly 10 kph) to its already monstrous strength”
- Climate change made the conditions fueling the hurricane 23 times more likely, compared to 14 times for El Niño. [bostonherald.com]
  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]
  [whec.com][wsls.com]
  > “Climate change made the conditions that fueled the hurricane 23 times more likely”
- Hurricane Polo set a record for spending two-and-a-half days as a Category 5 storm in the Pacific. [bostonherald.com]
  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]
  [whec.com][wsls.com]
  > “Polo set the record for time spent at Category 5 in the Pacific at two-and-a-half days.”
- Researchers compared actual conditions to a hypothetical pre-industrial world that has not warmed by 2.5 degrees.
  [bostonherald.com]
  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]
  [whec.com][wsls.com]
  > “comparing what happened in our warmer real world to a hypothetical world that hasn't warmed by 2.5 degrees”

In the image: A man wading through floodwaters carrying a mobile phone in Puerto San Carlos, Mexico, illustrating the localized impact of the storm.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 4 sources

bostonherald.com · economictimes.indiatimes.com · whec.com · wsls.com

You engaged with 7 of 13 Climate change stories you saw

Hashdex Nasdaq Crypto Index US ETF Sees Short Interest Drop

Short interest in the Hashdex Nasdaq Crypto Index US ETF declined significantly by 66.4% during the month of September.

- Short interest for the Hashdex Nasdaq Crypto Index US ETF fell substantially in September.

  [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "As of September 30th, there was short interest totaling 8,965 shares, a decline of 66.4%"

- The exchange-traded fund traded down during mid-day trading. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "NCIQ traded down $0.38 during mid-day trading on Wednesday, hitting $20.45."

- Institutional investors have recently adjusted their holdings in the company.

  [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "Institutional investors and hedge funds have recently bought and sold shares of the business."

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

themarketsdaily.com

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VictoryShares Core Intermediate Bond ETF Sees Surge in Short Interest

The VictoryShares Core Intermediate Bond ETF experienced a sharp rise in short interest alongside recent institutional investments and dividend updates.

- Short interest for the VictoryShares Core Intermediate Bond ETF rose significantly in September to 24,029 shares.

  [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "As of September 30th, there was short interest totaling 24,029 shares, an increase of 83.6% from the September 15th total"

- Bogart Wealth LLC increased its stake in the ETF by 3.6% during the first quarter. [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "Bogart Wealth LLC boosted its stake in VictoryShares Core Intermediate Bond ETF by 3.6% in the 1st quarter."

- The ETF recently announced a monthly dividend payout of $0.1861 per share.

  [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "Investors of record on Thursday, October 8th were given a dividend of $0.1861 per share."

- The fund is an actively managed bond fund based on the Bloomberg US Aggregate Bond index.

  [themarketsdaily.com]

  > "The fund is an actively managed bond fund that invests primarily in US issues with a dollar-weighted average maturity of three to ten years."

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

themarketsdaily.com

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AI Stock Declines Offset by Broader Market Gains on Wall Street

While artificial intelligence stocks face continued downward pressure, gains in other sectors are helping to maintain U.S. market stability.

- The Nasdaq composite experienced a slight decline due to weakness in AI stocks.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > "The weakness for AI stocks dragged the Nasdaq composite down 0.4%"

- The Dow Jones Industrial Average saw significant upward movement during midday trading.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > "the Dow Jones Industrial Average was up 440 points, or 0.9%"

- The S&P 500 remained relatively stable despite early losses.

  [economictimes.indiatimes.com]

  > "The S&P 500 was virtually unchanged in midday trading after erasing an early loss."

In the image: A cameraman is positioned in front of a large digital display showing various stock prices and market data in South Korea.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 2 sources

idahopress.com · economictimes.indiatimes.com

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ECONOMY, BUSINESS AND FINANCE



UK Economy Shows Unexpected GDP Growth

Official figures show that the UK economy has grown, confounding predictions that it would shrink.

- The UK economy has experienced surprising growth, contrary to predictions that it would shrink. [brfm.net]

> "The UK economy has grown, confounding predictions it would shrink, official figures show."

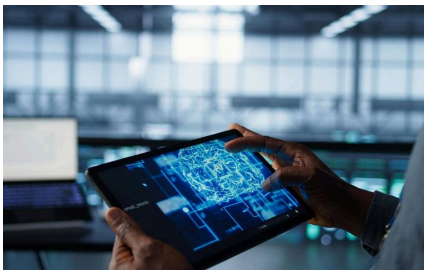
In the image: The image shows shoppers carrying Primark bags on a city street, which illustrates general consumer activity not mentioned in the text.

✓ 1 of 1 claims verified against sources · 1 source

brfm.net

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CLIMATE FINANCE AND CARBON MARKETS



AI's Climate Paradox: Balancing Heavy Energy Footprint with Environmental Tools

While data centres spark valid climate concerns, artificial intelligence simultaneously offers powerful solutions to enhance renewable energy grids, predict weather, and track global greenhouse gas emissions.

- The environmental impact of data centres and climate concerns will be a central topic at the upcoming COP31 climate summit in Türkiye. [thestar.com.my]

  > "The issue will be in the spotlight at the COP31 climate summit in Türkiye next month"

- The International Energy Agency projects that AI could save 13.5 exajoules of energy across the global economy by 2035. [thestar.com.my]

  > "the technology could save 13.5 exajoules of energy by 2035, equivalent to Indonesia's annual energy demand"

- AI has greatly accelerated weather forecasting, allowing researchers to achieve in two years what normally takes ten. [thestar.com.my]

  > "allowing the ECMWF to achieve in two years what would traditionally have taken 10 years to accomplish"

- Satellites combined with AI are utilized to track and pinpoint greenhouse gas emissions from specific industrial sites. [thestar.com.my]

  > "Satellites and AI are also used to spot greenhouse gas emissions from individual facilities such as oil and gas sites"

In the image: A person interacting with a tablet displaying a glowing neural network interface inside a control room.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

thestar.com.my

You engaged with 1 of 5 climate finance and carbon markets stories you saw



Baloch American Congress urges US to reject mineral deals in Balochistan

Tara Chand has written to President Trump asking the US administration to withhold support for mineral agreements made without local consent.

- Tara Chand has urged the US administration not to back mineral extraction agreements in Balochistan without the consent of the Baloch people. [ianslive.in]

  > “urging his administration to refrain from supporting mineral extraction agreements in Balochistan negotiated through Pakistani authorities”

- The letter highlights severe human rights concerns in Balochistan, including enforced disappearances and extrajudicial killings by Pakistani authorities. [ianslive.in]

  > “the Baloch activist raised concerns over enforced disappearances, extrajudicial killings, arbitrary detentions, and the repression of peaceful political activity”

- Chand called for independent international investigations into alleged human rights abuses in the region. [ianslive.in]

  > “calling for independent investigations into these alleged abuses.”

- The activist also warned that US investments should not reward repression or bypass the affected local population. [ianslive.in]

  > “Economic agreements must never reward repression or give those accused of abuses greater resources and legitimacy”

In the image: The image shows open-pit mining operations with heavy trucks and terraced mineral extraction sites, illustrating the scale of industrial resource exploitation mentioned in the text.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

ianslive.in

Exploring: a Pakistan story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more



Parents spend over £1,200 annually driving children to sports

New research reveals that parents spend an average of £1,216 a year on fuel while driving their children to sports.

- Parents spend an average of £1,216 annually on fuel to drive children to sports, covering about 1,716 miles. [express.co.uk]

  > “Parents of sporty kids spend on average £1,216 a year on fuel getting their children to training and matches”

- Football is the most common sport for these trips, with 61% of parents regularly transporting children to it. [express.co.uk]

  > “Football was found to be the most common sport these parents drive their children to, with 61% saying they regularly transport them”

- Three-quarters of parents reported missing important events, such as birthdays or work, to prioritize sports. [express.co.uk]

  > “Three quarters claimed they have had to miss out on something important to them, such as a social event, birthday or work commitment”

- Despite the costs, 91% agree that grassroots sports positively affect their children beyond just physical health. [express.co.uk]

  > “for most it's a job worth doing, with 91% agreeing their child taking part in grassroots sport has positively affected them”

In the image: The image shows a child wearing a colorful bucket hat and holding a soccer ball in the back seat of a car, which illustrates the article's focus on children participating in football and car journeys.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

express.co.uk

Exploring: a Sport story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more

You're caught up.

That's today's paper. Your next edition arrives tomorrow morning.